MA ENGLISH • SEMESTER 1

Block 1 — Unit 3: Methods of Teaching I

ENGLISH LANGUAGE TEACHING • M21EG01AC

Expanded exam notes | Simple teaching + developed argument

Based on the supplied SGOU self-learning material. Use the assigned primary texts for exact quotations and full scene or passage analysis.

The chapter in one sentence

Grammar Translation, the Direct Method, and the Audiolingual Method organise teaching around different assumptions about what language is and how it is learned.

Start with a picture

Three teachers introduce directions in a town. One explains rules and translates sentences; another uses a map and target-language interaction; a third models patterns for repeated oral practice. To compare them, ask what learners can do afterwards, not which name sounds newest.

1. Grammar Translation Method

Typical priorities include grammatical explanation, vocabulary lists, reading literary or other written texts, and translation between languages. The teacher often explains in a familiar language, and learners demonstrate accuracy through written answers.

Strengths and limits

Explicit explanation and cross-language comparison can make a difficult structure clear. Translation may be useful for analysis and particular goals. A full course dominated by rule recitation and isolated written translation can leave spontaneous listening and speaking underdeveloped.

Do not dismiss every use of translation as bad teaching or identify a method with the presumed ability of rural learners. Evaluate the purpose and actual task.

2. Direct Method

Meaning is established primarily through the target language, demonstration, objects, pictures, and interaction. Grammar is often approached inductively through examples. Oral questioning and everyday communication receive attention.

Strengths and limits

A map, gesture, or demonstration can link language with meaning and increase useful exposure. The method requires understandable input, skill, time, and suitable resources. A rigid refusal to use a known language can waste time or exclude learners when a brief explanation would help.

Inductive learning moves from examples towards a generalisation; **deductive** teaching begins with a stated rule and applies it.

3. Audiolingual Method

Historically connected with structural views of language and behaviourist accounts, it emphasises oral models, dialogues, repetition, and pattern drills. The teacher supplies a model, learners respond, and correction aims to establish a reliable form.

Substitution changes part of a pattern; transformation changes its structure; a chain drill passes a response around a group. A minimal-pair exercise can focus attention on a sound contrast.

Strengths and limits

Controlled practice can reduce hesitation and draw attention to form. Accurate repetition alone does not show that a learner can select the form appropriately in a new situation. A useful extension moves from drilling to a meaningful exchange with a reason to listen and respond.

4. Compare the same objective

Objective: ask for and give a route using clear sequence markers.

- Grammar Translation: explain imperatives and translate a short set of directions.
- Direct Method: model a route on a map and use questions in English to establish meaning.
- Audiolingual emphasis: practise patterns such as “Turn left at…” with substitutions.
- Transfer check: pairs have different destinations and must guide one another without reading a completed script.

The last task tests whether controlled knowledge transfers to use. Its results can guide the next lesson.

5. Role, material, and assessment

For each method, specify who selects language, how meaning is established, what learners actually do, how errors are treated, and which performance counts as success. “Teacher-centred” is not a sufficient explanation by itself.

6. Informed eclecticism

An eclectic teacher selects techniques for reasons connected with learner needs and evidence. A brief explanation, a model, some controlled practice, and a communicative task can work together if their purposes are explicit. Randomly combining fashionable activities is not a principled approach.

Learning outcome describes what a learner should be able to demonstrate; **strategy** is a planned means of reaching it; **technique** is a particular procedure.

Quick check

1. Is every translation activity the whole Grammar Translation Method? **No.**
2. Does correct drilling prove spontaneous communication? **No.**
3. Does eclectic mean using anything without a reason? **No.**

Build an exam answer

1. Define the three sets of priorities.
2. Compare teacher/learner roles and materials.
3. Explain a strength and limitation of each.
4. Design one aligned sequence.
5. Use a transfer task and feedback to evaluate it.

Common mistake to avoid

Do not treat translation as automatically harmful, native-language exclusion as automatically effective, or a completed drill as sufficient proof of communicative competence.

Developed exam discussion

Practice question

Compare the three methods and design a principled sequence using their useful resources.

Explain the argument in fuller paragraphs

The methods differ in what they prioritise. Grammar Translation gives explicit knowledge and written mediation a central place. The Direct Method seeks a close relation between target-language expression and experienced meaning. Audiolingual teaching organises oral practice through models and patterns. Each creates opportunities, but none establishes every language skill merely by carrying out its characteristic activity.

A route-giving lesson can make the comparison concrete. A teacher may briefly explain a difficult form using a familiar language, demonstrate it on a map, and provide a limited substitution drill to reduce processing pressure. These stages should prepare learners for a task in which a partner genuinely lacks the information needed to reach a destination. The lesson is coherent because all stages support one outcome.

Assessment then separates reproduction from transfer. The teacher observes whether directions are understandable, whether the listener can seek clarification, and whether relevant forms are used accurately enough for the goal. A learner who repeats perfectly but cannot respond to a new destination needs a different next step from one who communicates successfully with a recurring form error.

A strong answer therefore avoids declaring one historical method entirely useless or universally superior. It compares assumptions, roles, materials, feedback, and outcomes, then justifies selection through context and evidence. The goal is principled pedagogy rather than loyalty to a label.

Use the discussion well

Answer the exact question, not every possible topic. Make one clear point per paragraph, support it with a textual detail or a relevant classroom example, and explain its significance. Check exact quotations against the assigned text. The discussion is paraphrase and guidance, not a quotation or a guaranteed exam answer.

Textbook assignment checklist

The following numbered prompts are retained from the unit for revision. Obvious source errors are discussed in the coverage review; a prompt's assumptions should not be accepted automatically. These are not predictions or complete written assignments.

1. Though the Grammar Translation Method is outdated, there are teachers who continue to use it particularly in rural areas. Give reasons citing the advantages of the method.
2. "The direct method tries to establish an immediate association between experience and expression, words and phrases and performances through the teachers' body and mental skills". Explain how such a method can help one to learn a language like English.
3. Extensive memorisation, repetition and over-learning of patterns are the essence of the Audio-lingual Method. Explain
4. Elucidate Grammar Translation Method.
5. Explain Direct method in teaching with an example.
6. Define Audio-lingual Method.
7. What is meant by Eclectic Approach
8. What is the term 'strategy' refer in language learning?